

# Erin N. King

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## EDUCATION

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**Master of Human-Computer Interaction (MHCI)** | Iowa State University | GPA: 4.0 | Dec 2025

**B.S. Cognitive Science (HCI & AI) & B.A. Intensive Psychology** | UC Santa Cruz | Honors | 2022

## SKILLS

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**Research:** Usability Testing, Think-Aloud Protocol, Semi-Structured Interviews, Thematic Analysis, Contextual Inquiry, Qualitative Coding (Taguette), Content Analysis, Cognitive Engineering, Design Ethnography, Research Synthesis, Mixed Methods Research, Survey Design, Field Studies, Participant Recruitment, CITI Ethics

**Design:** Figma, Miro, Mural, Design Systems, Prototyping, Wireframing, Inclusive Design, Information Architecture, UX Writing

**Tools:** HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Shopify (Liquid), AI-Assisted Code (Lovable/Claude), Qualtrics, axe DevTools

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Web Development & UX Consultant** | Independent Contractor | Mar 2024 - Present

- Led Shopify theme migration for an inherited storefront, preserving custom functionality and resolving post-migration technical debt.
- Built dynamic product linking with Shopify Metaobjects and trained the client team to maintain the feature independently.
- Applied WCAG 2.2 standards within client constraints, including a promotional banner that pauses on hover and decluttered copy across key pages.
- Designed and built an event landing site on a platform chosen so the client could self-maintain after handoff; set up SEO keeping the site at or near the top of Google results for its primary event queries; supported event cycles drawing 3,000+ sessions and 100+ ticket orders in a 30-day window.
- Conducted a pro bono website accessibility audit, identified usability barriers, and presented findings with prioritized recommendations.

**Accessibility & Advocacy Internships** | Santa Cruz, CA | Jan 2022 - Jun 2022

- **Monarch Independent Living:** Produced accessible educational media, including cooking tutorial videos and custom-designed games, for adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities, prioritizing cognitive ease and comprehension.
- **Laurel Street Center:** Implemented person-centered care and developed virtual learning programs adapted to individual needs, supporting consumer independence and community inclusion.

## RESEARCH & DESIGN PROJECTS

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**Storytelling in Disability Spaces on Reddit** / *Qualitative Research, Thematic Analysis*

- Conducted five semi-structured interviews and applied inductive thematic analysis to synthesize user narratives into design recommendations for inclusive digital spaces.

**AI Transparency & User Trust** / *Qualitative Research, Human-AI Interaction*

- Conducted a qualitative study on how users evaluate ChatGPT credibility through iterative prompting sessions; found that structural and tonal cues drive trust judgments more than source citations.

**Distracted Walking: Urban Pedestrian Behavior**

- Collaborated on a distributed research team across three cities to analyze mobile device impact on safety; synthesized observational data to map urban navigation patterns.

**Hades: Cognitive Load & Expert Performance** / *Cognitive Engineering*

- Measured how attentional overload affects expert and novice performance under varying task demands, applying cognitive engineering frameworks to interface design implications.

**EduFlow: Digital Transformation & Design Systems**

- Developed a scalable Atomic Design system with accessibility built in; utilized AI-assisted coding tools (Lovable/Claude) to deploy a functional web application.

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- CITI Program: Social/Behavioral Research - Basic Course (Human Research Ethics)

- Google UX Design Specialization | IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner | IBM Team Essentials for AI